

Info session Good writing

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University of Applied Sciences Europe
Iserlohn · Berlin · Hamburg

Welcome to the info session: Writing Good thesis

- Formal requirements
- Looking at a good thesis
- Resources for writing a thesis
- Academic Format writing

University of Applied Sciences Europe

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Formal requirements

Deadline

- **Is non-negotiable!**
- Ask for the extension in a timely manner – a week before the thesis is due
- If you fall sick in between, get a doctor's note and sent it to the examination office!
- Do not let the deadline pass and then tell everybody about the misfortune that ha befallen you!

Formal requirements

Presentation Registration

DSC04 Master Thesis Colloquium 120A-B:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1PKYdRrOdgL5dY0SGQms2Mxkq9JwYMnhY4GjaPBBVE-U/edit?usp=sharing

DSC03 Master Thesis Colloquium 90:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1Nj34mtwGmS19NJ9FkwyZXLH3qFtE1y7OfD_fJ7mZrt0/edit?usp=sharing

SE Master Thesis Colloquium 60-90-120:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/13CMfSa86lad7N_ryBo8OK_fuM2ORqwQ4hoMjaIl_uG8/edit?usp=sharing

Formal requirements

Size

Kind of thesis	Volume	Time frame
Master 60 ECTS	55,000 – 62000 characters without spaces	12 weeks plus 2 weeks extensions upon approval
Master 90 ECTS	60,000 – 70000 characters without spaces	14 weeks plus 2 weeks extensions upon approval
Master 120 ECTS	72,000 – 82,000 characters without spaces	16 weeks plus 3 weeks extensions upon approval

Formal requirements

Plagiarism

- **Is non-negotiable – you cheat, you are out!**
- What is cheating: using somebody's intellectual property and not marking it as such by employing proper citation standards
- What are proper standards for academic citation:
  - Please refer to the brochure "Handreichung zum wissenschaftlichen Arbeiten" in English and German
- We use software the check for plagiarism!
- Do not uses AI in writing,

Formal requirements

Supervisors

- You need two supervisors
  - One of the two has to be a tenured professor of this university – Prof. Dr.!
- The first supervisor will do the supervising and mentoring
- The second supervisor does only read the thesis
- External lecturers will usually only be first supervisor as second supervisors are not being paid for their efforts
- Ask your supervisor for feedback **before** your hand in the thesis
  - Once you submit it to the examination office, it is too late

Formal requirements

Failed Attempt

- There are many reasons to fail your first attempt
  1. Plagiarism more than 10%
  2. Missing the deadline
  3. Writing an essay but not a thesis
  4. Writing on a level not appropriate for a bachelor/master of science degree
  5. Missing the minimum requirements concerning signs
  6. Writing your Thesis using LLMs and AI is above 20%
  7. **Wrong citation**
- You have a second attempt but not a third!
- You have to re-register under a new topic
- You loose time and money. Better get it right the first time!

Formal requirements

Attention to detail

- Please read the email carefully that the examination sends you to confirm your registration
- Please read the “Handreichung zum wissenschaftlichen Arbeiten” brochure carefully
- Get feedback from your supervisor!

Looking at a good thesis

Research methodology

- Opt for a research methodology and critically discuss it
  - Why this one and not the other one
  - Advantages and disadvantages
- **Cite authors** that support your view
- Show that you have read some literature on the topic and cite it!
- If you do not do research yourself, describe the pros and cons of a thesis based solely on literature research
  - Describe that method as well and list the kind of literature review that you are doing

Looking at a good thesis

Literature review

- Student have to proof that they know how to summarize the current state of the scientific discussion
- The most important authors have to be cited
- Makes a major portion of your thesis

Looking at a good thesis

Thesis Structure

Statutory Declaration:

I hereby declare that I have developed and written the enclosed Master Thesis completely by myself and have not used sources or means without declaration in the text. I clearly marked and separately listed all the literature and all the other sources which I employed when producing this academic work, either literally or in content. I am aware that the violation of this regulation will lead to failure of the thesis.

Berlin, ...
Place, Date

Looking at a good thesis

Thesis Structure

Cover Sheet
- Content Overview (?)

Statutory Declaration

Table of Contents
- Indices
- List of abbreviations
- List of tables
- List of figures

Abstract
Chapter 1: Introduction
    2% weightage

Looking at a good thesis

Thesis Structure

Chapter 2, 3…: ……Theoretical Background (Literature Review)

15 % weightage

Describe the quality of cited sources

Hierarchy of sources

- Peer reviewed journals
- Journals by IEEE, Sage, Springer, Elsevier, Blackwell, Taylor & Frances etc.
- Monographies (Books by author teams on one subject) (Publishing house counts as well)
- **Internet Sources* (Not recommended)**

Looking at a good thesis

Thesis Structure

Chapter ..4.. Research Question

1% weightage

Methodology

5% weightage

Chapter ..5.. Results

- Discussion
  - 15% weightage
  - Own opinions come here
  - Own conclusions come here (?)
  - Practical application

Chapter ..6.. Conclusion and Future Work:

- Implications and future research

5% weightage

Chapter ..7.. Bibliography

Resources for writing a thesis

Software

- Employ academic writing software:
  - Citavi, Endnote, Zotero, **Latex**…
- Without software you easily loose track of your sources
- You will make citation errors

Resources for writing a thesis

Hardware and Backups

- Have reliable hardware to start with – you cannot write the thesis on a smartphone
- You have an Office365 license with the ue-germany.de mail. Use it!
- Always make backups! No backup, no compassion!
  - The original files is on your hard drive
  - Make a daily backup on your hard drive: name_thesis_yearmonthday (mythesis_20210428)
  - Have a backup in the cloud
  - Make a print-out once in a while and give it to a friend
  - Mail a softcopy to a friend

Resources for writing a thesis

Library

- The UE library is reachable from the internet: http://www.bits-hochschule.de/en/library/
- You can research at any Berlin university library
- Use researchgate.net, Google Scholar, ect.
- Search the internet for open access journals
- The better your sources, the better your thesis!

Academic Format writing

Paper length and layout

- M.Sc. Thesis usually consist of 50 pages of text at 35 lines each approximately (approximately meaning here, that a tolerance of +/- 10% or five pages is being considered acceptable).
- Should you include a larger number of tables and figures in your text, the length of your paper increases proportionately.
- Layout wise, please allow margins of 2cm to the left, 4cm to the right, 2,5cm to the top and 3cm to the bottom of a regular DIN A4 page.
- When printing, please print **only to one side of standard** white (80 grams) paper.
- Fontwise, please use either **Arial, Times New Roman, or Cambria, with the font size being 12pt** for the text body (and 10pt for footnotes).
- The standard font color is black!

Academic Format writing

Paragraph Layout

Intendent 1 cm

1.3 Title

Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless drag-and-drop editing experience for writers, editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people who work with content. Unlike Layout Builder in Drupal core, Layout Paragraphs is not a site building tool. Rather, Layout Paragraphs is an authoring tool. (Also note that Layout Paragraphs is compatible with Layout Builder, meaning both can be installed and used on the same site.)

Justify

6 Points

Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless drag-and-drop editing experience for writers, editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people who work with content. Unlike Layout Builder in Drupal core.

- Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless,
- Drag-and-drop editing experience for writers,
- Editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people who work with content. Unlike Layout Builder in Drupal core,

Layout Paragraphs is not a site building tool. Rather, Layout Paragraphs is an authoring tool. (Also note that Layout Paragraphs is compatible with Layout Builder, meaning both can be installed and used on the same site.)

Academic Format writing

Outline structure

For your outline, please utilize the numerical designation following DIN 1421.

It uses a whole-number decimal system for organizing chapters and subchapters, where each decimal (i.e. hierarchy level) is separated from the other by a point.

Chapter Two: Title…..

2.1 Title

Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless drag-and-drop editing experience for writers, editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people who work with content. Unlike Layout Builder in Drupal core, Layout Paragraphs is not a site building tool. Rather, Layout Paragraphs is an authoring tool. (Also note that Layout Paragraphs is compatible with Layout Builder, meaning both can be installed and used on the same site.)

2.1.1 Title

Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless drag-and-drop editing experience for writers, editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people who work with content. Unlike Layout Builder in Drupal core.

2.1.2 Title

Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless drag-and-drop editing experience for writers, editors, and marketers.

- Layout Paragraphs provides an effortless,
- Drag-and-drop editing experience for writers,
- Editors, and marketers. It has been designed from the ground up to meet the needs of people

Academic Format writing

Outline structure

- Please keep in mind that in terms of structural logic, you do need a subchapter 2.2, when you have a subchapter 2.1.
- For readability purposes and to clarify the hierarchy of your text, it is advisable to indent the captions of subordinate chapters.

Example

1
2
    2.1
    2.2
        2.2.1

- The table of contents documents the entirety of all chapters and subchapters of your paper with their numerical designations and page number. The latter is right-aligned and separated from the chapter title by dots .....

Example

2 E-research: internet research methods.....21

- Do not structure deeper than the fourth hierarchy level (i.e. 2.3.4.5 at most).

Academic Format writing

References and citations

- The literature addressing the formalities of preparing scholarly papers is ripe with differing citation conventions.
- Please remember the vital importance of deciding on certain procedures and sticking to them throughout the entire paper (e.g. when you decide to abbreviate the first name(s) of an author you consulted, do so with all other authors as well).
- Citing in scholarly papers is always a threefold procedure consisting of the following components:
    1. The actual quote or paraphrase,
    2. The reference (taking either the form of a footnote or in-text citation),
    3. The record, that is, the full bibliographic details of a source, compiled in the bibliography.

Academic Format writing

References and citations

- Direct quotations are the verbatim repetition of another author's words, which you use and copy into your own text. This form of citation should be used sparingly.
- It is best put to use when the particular "wording of a given issue is especially important" (Bryman, et all 2012).
- Direct quotations do report the original literally. The entire text and all specific features of the original (e.g. underlined or bold text, also spelling mistakes) need to be reproduced to the letter. Direct quotations must be placed inside quotation marks " "

Example

"Conducting research by using the Internet as a method of data collection raises specific ethical issues [...] [with] some of those in volved in research with this new technology [..] not adhering to ethical principles."[1]

[1] Bryman (2012), p. 679.

Academic Format writing

Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing represents the standard way of referring to the works and ideas of other authors in scholarly writing.

When paraphrasing, you reproduce and summarize the idea of another author‘s thoughts and ideas in your own words.

Formally, there is only one difference when referencing a paraphrase: the reference (footnote or in-text citation) is preceded by the qualifier **cf**., meaning that the section of text in question is based on the source you give.

Academic Format writing

Reference

Use the Harvard system, which is a name and date system.

- It uses an abbreviated or partial reference that consists only of the author's last name, publication year and page number.
- These key data allow for safe identification of any resource in the bibliography.

Academic Format writing

Reference

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Examples

[1] Bryman (2014), p. 7.

[2] Cf. Bryman, Hardy 2009: 253.

Academic Format writing

Reference

- When citing several resources by the same author from the same year, differentiate them by adding a lower case letter directly to the publication year.

Example

[1] Cf. Bryman (2011): 5.
[2] Cf. Bryman (2011a): 113.
[3] Cf. Bryman (2011b): 15.

Academic Format writing

Reference

- If the original quote extend to the next page, please add an **f.** directly to the page number in your reference.
- When paraphrasing a longer section of text spanning more than two pages of the original source, add **ff.** in the same way.

Examples

[1] Bryman (2011), p. 5f.

[2] Cf. Jaspers 1997: 23ff.

Academic Format writing

IEEE Citation Style

- IEEE style is a numbered referencing style that uses citation numbers in the text of the paper, provided in square brackets.
- The in-text citations numbers start at the number [1], and continue in the ascending order they appear throughout your writing, as in the example here.
- If you wish to refer to the same source several times, simply repeat the earlier citation number and then use the same number in all subsequent citations throughout the body of the paper.
- A full corresponding reference is listed at the end of the paper, next to the respective citation number.

Academic Format writing

Bibliography

- The bibliography documents all sources cited throughout the text in **alphabetical** order, using the name-date principle.
- General bibliography rule: do not overdo! One neatly collated, alphabetical list usually is more than sufficient.

Example
Persson, K. (2012): An economic history of Europe: knowledge, institutions and growth, 600 to the present. Cambridge.

- When a source has more than one author, up to three authors are mentioned and separated by a semicolon **;** from one another

Example
Larson, E.; Gray, C. (2014): Project management: the managerial process. New York.

Academic Format writing

Bibliography

- When a source has more than three authors, only the first author is mentioned together with the indication et al. (et alii = and others).

Example
Aaker, D. et al. (2013): Marketing research. Hoboken.

- The publication details for bibliographically dependent works include: author name(s), publication year, title and sub-title(s) of article, name of the publishing journal or newspaper, volume and issue number, and pagination for the entire article

Example
Alexandris, K. (2014): Marketing sport event tourism: sport tourist behaviors and destination provisions. In: Sport marketing quarterly, 23(3), pp. 125-126.

Academic Format writing

Bibliography

- When compiling your online sources for the bibliography, please give author name(s), full title, full link, and access date. If available, give a permanent link (e.g. DOI, URN) instead of a URL. Further details (e.g. series title) may be added where available

Example

Sloan, L. et al. (2015): Who tweets? Deriving the demographic characteristics of age, occupation and social class from Twitter user meta-data.
Available through: http://orca.cf.ac.uk/id/eprint/71302
[Accessed 11 May 2015]

Academic Format writing

Tables and figures

- Add a caption right underneath each figure /table.
- Figures /tables should be incorporated into the text body where the questions they are supposed to be shedding further light on are debated.
- They should be referred to in the accompanying text itself.
- Self-provided figures /tables do not need to referenced. They do need to be captioned however as well as being listed in your list of tables / figures, should you include one in your Thesis.

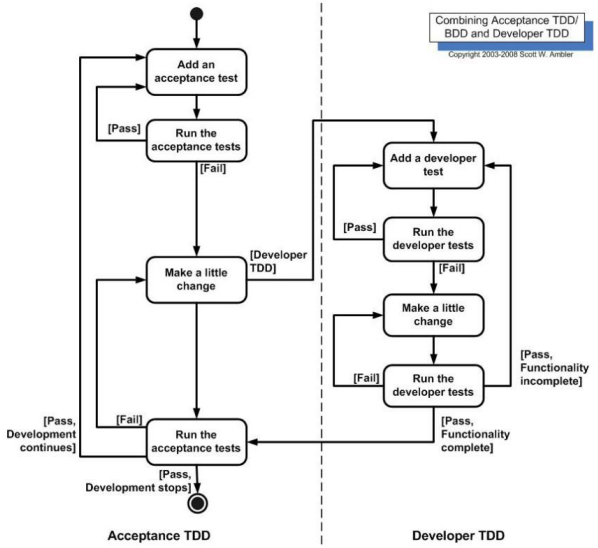


Figure 2 TDD cycle in agile modern driven development

Academic Format writing

Mathematical Equations

A mathematical expression usually contains several parameters. All the parameters in the thesis have to be defined on their first appearance. However, they shouldn't be the first word of any sentence.

- Mathematical parameters should be written in italics,
- Use the same font size for mathematical expressions as the font size of the text.
- The equations that are written on a separate line are either indented or centred, but done consistently throughout the thesis.
- If an equation breaks to multiple lines, align them properly and use only one number for the whole equation as far to the right as possible.
- x is represent the value of age, and m the range, as shown in (4.1) [16]

$$x = \frac{r}{\sqrt[3]{m}} \qquad (4.1)$$

Academic Format writing

Mathematical Equations

- If an equation breaks to multiple lines, align them properly and use only one number for the whole equation as far to the right as possible.
- Provide some vertical space above and below the equations that are displayed in separate lines.
- Equations are regarded as being a part of the text, and are punctuated accordingly. If it is the end of a sentence, there should be a period at the end of the equation; otherwise put a comma at the end of it.
- Do not capitalize or indent “where” or “with” when listing variables following an equation.

Academic Format writing

Mathematical Equations

For numbering the first type of equations, i.e., those which are going to be referred somewhere in the thesis:

- The equation numbers should be enclosed by parentheses and placed at the right-hand side of the page.
- If you are referring to an equation in the text, use eq. (3) (or other abbreviations). If it is the first word in a sentence, capitalize it, i.e., Eq. (3). It is also pretty normal to refer to an equation in the text with only its number within parentheses, like "(3)".
- In this case, if it is the first word in the sentence, spell out "Equation" before the number, like "Equation (3)".

Mathematical Equations

Resources

Overleaf Template — Tech Bachelor's:
https://www.overleaf.com/read/nvbjzkqkvwcx#036d2b

Overleaf Template — Tech Master's:
https://www.overleaf.com/read/xkywsyxtqvfd#039c70

Attached: UE Overleaf user manual

Please confirm that this workflow is acceptable to all instructors.


Thanks for listening and good luck with the exam!
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